[CASE STUDY · CAMPAIGN DIRECTOR · 2025–26]

Texans for Lange

A first-time candidate, a statewide race and a pandemic. How we put a new name in front of Texas.

Hakeem · Expressive Space


[Julian Onderdonk, Bluebonnets at Sunrise, 1917]

[THE CHALLENGE]

A new name, in the year no one could shake hands.

[A] **No name recognition**

Michael's first run for office, launched in the middle of COVID.

[B] **Virtual events fell flat**

Online town halls couldn't build the trust a room full of people does.

[C] **No support**

One month in, the campaign director fell ill. Michael was left running it alone.



[Julian Onderdonk, Approaching Rain, Southwest Texas, 1922] A lot of ground to cover, and weather coming in.

[THE APPROACH]

A campaign that works as hard as the campaigner.

I stepped in as campaign director and ran everything behind the scenes, so Michael could do what he does best: campaign. When the work behind him matched the work he put in, his effort went just as far.



[Julian Onderdonk, A White Road at Late Afternoon, 1921]

[HOW]

Most candidates work only the top 10 counties. We went where the impact was greatest.

We focused on underserved areas that rarely see a statewide campaign, where showing up counted most.

80+ — Appearances
In the counties other campaigns skip.

Local — Micro-local club sponsors
Very local clubs in each community backing the campaign.

Gen Z [SOCIAL]

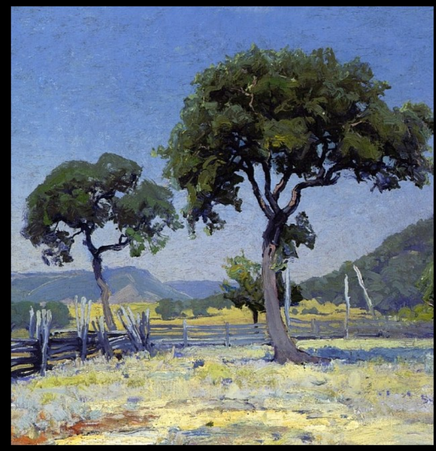


5M

views on fun, fast reels

[Onderdonk, Bluebonnet Scene with a Girl, 1920]

Boomers [PAID]



10M

views on paid Facebook

[Onderdonk, Live Oaks, Bandera County, 1915]

350
Pieces of content

12
Podcasts

12
Radio appearances



[Julian Onderdonk, In the Hills, Southwest Texas, 1912]

[WHAT I RAN]

Seven jobs. One director.

Brand design

A visual identity built to make a new name stick.

Messaging

One clear story Michael could tell in any county.

Website

Home base for voters, volunteers and donors.

Event strategy

Routing and booking in-person stops, week after week.

Content creation

Photo and video from the road, shared the same day.

Paid media

Targeted ads that took each stop far past the room.

Social

Always-on channels that kept the conversation going.

All of it ran behind the scenes, so Michael could stay in front of voters.



[RESULTS]

From unknown to a name Texas knew.

100
Counties visited

10 / week
Events, on average

15M
Views across paid and social media

150K
Website visitors

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